

The Sin Unto Death

I just love the book of First John. You are not really going to understand it without some element of love in there.

Otherwise, you go from one end of the road to the other, from ultra-holiness hellfire and brimstone that sends you to hell over an earring, and we are talking about women, not men, to statements that seem to have no middle ground. John says, "He that sins is of the devil." Boy, where does that leave most people? Of course, not present company.

Then you get to the end, and he says there is a sin not unto death. All unrighteousness is sin. I thought you said, "He that sins is of the devil." Then he says, "There is a sin not unto death. Pray for that. But there is a sin unto death, and I do not say you should pray for it."

So you are walking in all this love and making these big negative statements. That is why, when we preach out of this book, we usually just take a few verses here and there, so we can sleep.

The key to understanding First John is the born-again trail. Somewhere along the line, a person has to begin to understand the love of God. I can remember getting close enough to the love of God at different times that I could anticipate there was much I did not know yet, and I wanted to know it.

When He gave me the born-again trail, many things began to straighten out. Then I got close enough for Him to give me another key on private worship. Worship is more of an inroad into the love of God than anything.

Then I began to understand more about Him and His nature. I began to interpret some of God's actions by His nature, such as with the Old Testament saints. He loved them, but His fellowship with them was limited by their death nature. He loved them and did the best He could, but He had to put them under law because that is the way the death nature is.

A person must understand the difference between the Old Covenant and ours, which produced our sonship. The old saints were saved, but they were saved waiting for a predestined date:

For whom he did foreknow, he also did predestinate
to be conformed to the image of his Son,
that he might be the firstborn among many brethren.

The predestination took place because there had to be an image to conform to. Who was there to conform to until the Firstborn was born?

The first thing Jesus did was empty out Abraham's bosom and every other place that held people who held on to the promise. That promise had been given in different ways. To Adam, it was the promise that the seed of the woman would bruise Satan's head.

Even in the sacrifices, Cain's did not please God. Satan was at his door, desiring to reign over him. Cain offered a sacrifice with no blood in it, whereas Abel offered blood, which already spoke of Jesus' atoning blood.

Do you think God created animal skins to clothe Adam and Eve when their death nature told them they were naked, or do you think the first sacrifices died, the first sacrifice that met their need?

Cain's countenance fell because he did not offer the right sacrifice. He was enraged, and the desire Satan had for him was to reign over him. Then he killed his brother and was banished to the land of Nod, east of Eden, separated even farther east.

Satan has always needed someone to reign through. Cain's first son was Enoch, and Cain named the first city after him. A dictator cannot manifest Satan's will, atrocities, power to kill, and power to take everything people have unless Satan has someone to reign through.

Cain's line went on to Lamech, who married Adah and Zillah. Adah had Jabal and Jubal. Zillah had Tubal-cain, an artificer of brass and iron, and a sister named Naamah. Tubal-cain smelted brass and iron. What do you think he was making, nice jewelry to sell at the swap meet? Try weapons of war.

Lamech murdered a young man to his hurt, just like his forefather. Naamah was the first woman named after Eve, Adah, and Zillah. She was a seductress who moved in on the lineage of the sons of God during a time of revival.

The wisest man in the world was Solomon. When Jesus referred to wisdom, He used Solomon as an example. Yet seductresses disarmed him. When Jesus said, "A greater than Solomon is here," He meant Solomon could take you to the edge of the rebirth, but he could not bring you in. Jesus brought us in.

God loved the Old Testament saints, but His fellowship with them was limited by their death nature.

When Jesus sat down with the Samaritan woman at the well, I had no idea what was in that conversation, but it changed my life when I understood it. He said the water He would give would spring forth from a well. The Holy Ghost is the river that flows, but the life He was talking about comes from a well.

He said, "You drink My water, and you will never thirst again." For what? For being born again. You will never thirst again.

Then He said:

The hour cometh, and now is,
when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth:
for the Father seeketh such to worship him.

On the millennial time clock, the hour breaks down to a generation. Jesus was saying, "The time now is when I am going to die. You are going to receive a new nature, and when you do, you will be able to worship God in spirit and in truth. The Father seeks such to worship Him."

Was He running around looking for a good worship team? No. He waited through four thousand years of dispensations until the first men and women appeared on this planet born again and could finally give Him the fellowship He longed for out of that new nature.

You have to understand the love of God to understand what is in this book. He is seeking you out. For four thousand years, generation after generation waited for Jesus. He came, and now we can worship Him in spirit out of a nature that is just like His.

The truth part puzzled me for a long time. Jesus said, "I am the way, the truth, and the life," but what did He mean by worshiping in truth? God had to take me into a parable, and out came Gospel Duck, Chucky the Duck.

Somebody slipped a duck egg into a hen's nest. This duck was raised as a chicken and thought he was a chicken. Poor little guy. He had the spirit of a duck but thought he was a chicken. The others scratched around eating bugs, but he could hardly pick them up off the ground. He was starving. His brothers mocked him: "Fat mouth. What happened to your feet? The girls at school are not going to like you."

One day he roamed near a pond. He looked at that water, and something told him. Nobody had ever taught him to swim. What could tell him that? His nature. So he ran down and jumped in. One of his brothers ran and told Mama Hen, "You know what Wacko is doing now? He is in the water."

Mama Hen ran down to the pond, clucking like a wet hen: "Whatever possessed you? Get yourself out of there." She tanned his little tail feathers, but he could not help it. He kept sneaking down.

One day a flock of ducks came in. They said, "Hi, duck."

He said, "I am not a duck. I am a chicken."

They took a while to quit laughing. "No, you are a duck. Look in the water. Look at us."

He looked at his reflection and at them and said, "You are right. I am, am I not?"

They said, "Yes. Let us show you something else you can do." They flapped, lifted off, came back around, and said, "Come on. Let's go."

He lifted off the ground and flew around. He could not resist it. His brothers and sisters were playing in the barnyard, and he swooped so low he rolled three of them.

"You were wrong. I am going to amount to something. I am heading south to the promised land. Mom, I love you, but I cannot stay here."

When he got south, he found the Lord Duck. "How can I ever thank You for sending those evangelists out there?"

The Lord Duck said, "You want to thank Me? Fly. Just fly."

To worship Him in spirit and truth is to fly. I may have been limited, but not anymore. Miracles are not impossible. All things are possible to him that believes. Greater works than these shall you do because Jesus went to the Father. How can I please Him? How can I worship Him in spirit and truth? Just fly. You have that nature. Lift off. You can do it.

I have been born again, and so have you. There is more we are to know about this walk in the Spirit and this walk of power, and are we not finding it out day by day?

The main pattern of this book walks down the born-again trail. In the first chapter, John divides light from darkness. Light, in God with no darkness at all, represents being born again, the new nature received. Darkness represents spiritual death.

I knew that from assimilating the Gospel of John. John said things that corresponded with this and caused me to understand his later teachings after I had walked in love for a good deal of time.

John 1 says:

In the beginning was the Word,
and the Word was with God,
and the Word was God.

The Word became flesh and dwelt among us. When he described Jesus as the Logos, He was with God and He was God. That is something: to be with someone and be them. That is the Godhead right there. He did not mention the Holy Spirit in that verse, but we know He is the One we call the third Person of the Godhead.

In First John, he calls them the three in heaven that bear record:

the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost:
and these three are one.

They do not just agree as one. These three are one. The three Persons of the Godhead make up the one true and living God.

In the beginning was the Word. He was with God, He was God, all things were made by Him, and in Him was life. The life was the light of men. That light shined in darkness, the spiritually dead state of the human race, and the darkness did not comprehend it.

John speaks in First John as if you already know these things. He calls the second Person of the Godhead the mighty Logos. For our creation, the Father took the role of planning; Jesus did the creating; and the Holy Spirit did the regenerating. But we make a mistake when we diminish the Holy Spirit's position of equality with the other two members. These three are one, tri-equal, with no diminishment.

The tri-equal Holy Spirit has come here to take up His abode in the light He has given you and teach you.

At the birth of the Church, many could not read. The early Church did not even have Paul's letters. They went to the synagogue to get Scripture, and even that was hard to come by. So who came at the birth of the Church? The Holy Spirit.

One of the first things He did was manifest diversities of tongues. As many as heard them speak, heard them speak in their own languages. The early world had one language, and the devil evangelized it. God confounded the language at the Tower of Babel. The whole earth was one company, and in the days of Peleg, the earth was divided. It did not happen overnight; it took time.

This time, God united people in an incredible way. It did not matter whether you could read. It did not matter what language you spoke. All you had to do was get the basic truth over to them so they could understand who they had received and who had just healed them. Get them filled and teach them to pray. Immediately every bridge is gapped. Every culture and understanding that deviates from each other is bridged.

The Holy Spirit will teach them, according to their surroundings, who God is by breaching every stronghold. God sent the third Person, nothing diminished, to come and teach us.

"I cannot even think of what to pray."

Excuse me. God the Holy Spirit not only knows God's whole plan for you, but He knows where you are called and what you are going to do.

"You cannot read? You do not know much? How about letting Me do some of your praying? I will take it out of the mind of Christ, pray it for you, and the Father will answer it."

One member of the Godhead originates the prayer, and the other two answer it. He borrows your spirit because it has to be you praying. That is why Paul said, "If I pray in an unknown tongue, my spirit prayeth." The Holy Spirit creates that language in your spirit, and your mouth shapes the words He is creating. It finishes the circuit of power. Now you are praying it. He needed your spirit for the authority, and once you pray it, it is you praying.

It seems to me failure is going over the horizon.

The more He taught me about the love of God, the more I could look into His nature and understand things like His longing to fellowship with Old Testament saints, though fellowship was limited by their nature. He had to put them under law. The only law I am under is the law of the

Spirit, which is life.

The Ten Commandments have become part of your nature. You do not have to try. Your conscience bears witness, and your thoughts meanwhile accuse or excuse one another. The new nature accuses thoughts that are not right, and whatever it accuses, I will not excuse.

That is the standard by which we will be judged by Paul's gospel in that day. "The devil made me do it" will not fly too well there.

Because John uses darkness to explain the spiritually dead state and light to explain what God brought in the form of a spirit free from sin, I could finally understand parts of First John that used to confuse me.

For example:

Every spirit that confesseth not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is not of God.

I watched holiness preachers hold people down and say, "Did Jesus come in the flesh?" Sometimes the devil would say, "Yes," and the preacher would get mixed up.

But when John made that statement, he was referring to teachers who were coming and perverting the Word. He was talking about antichrist. That is what he meant when he said:

These things have I written unto you concerning them that seduce you.
But the anointing which ye have received of him abideth in you,
and ye need not that any man teach you:
but as the same anointing teacheth you of all things,
and is truth, and is no lie.

He was not doing away with teaching. He was saying that if somebody is disarming you from the pulpit and seducing you, then the Teacher of teachers on the inside will check you and tell you what he is doing.

Amen.

First John 1:4 says:

And these things write we unto you,
that your joy may be full.

Then verse 5:

This then is the message which we have heard of him,
and declare unto you,
that God is light,
and in him is no darkness at all.

If we say we have fellowship with Him and walk in darkness, we lie and do not the truth. In other words, if someone says, "I am in great fellowship with Christ," but there is no sign of any of the Ten Commandments written inside him, and he is walking in darkness with an unregenerate spirit, he is lying.

But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship one with another, and the blood of Jesus Christ cleanses us from all sin. If a man walking in darkness says, "I am fine. I have no sin," he deceives himself and the truth is not in him.

John later says:

Beloved, believe not every spirit,
but try the spirits whether they are of God:
because many false prophets are gone out into the world.
Hereby know ye the Spirit of God:
Every spirit that confesseth that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is of God:
And every spirit that confesseth not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is not of God:
and this is that spirit of antichrist.

When he says every spirit, he is not talking about demons so much as the influence of the devil over a person, especially false prophets and preachers. Any preacher who comes through and teaches that Jesus Christ did not manifest in the flesh, that is the spirit of antichrist, and you are not to believe him.

Once you understand the theme, you understand why John draws a line. The theme of the whole book is that if you have truly been born again, it is going to show up somewhere. Something has to change. You cannot deny foundational truth, live with no sign of the commandments in you, and claim the new nature without it showing up.

God will walk through hell with a believer who is in trouble, a baby walking into God and not out of Him, who loves God though the devil and hell are beating him up. As long as he hates the sin as badly as God does and wants out of it, God will walk through hell with him because he is in transition. The new nature will keep bringing the flesh under subjection if he keeps walking in the Spirit.

But when you turn around and start justifying the sin, you are walking out.

He was manifested to take away our sin, not to give us permission to live next to hell and make it into heaven anyway. There are people who wrestle with sin all their lives and love God because that is what they were taught from the pulpit. But we do not have to waddle around in the chicken yard all our lives. We can fly.

First John 5:3 says:

For this is the love of God,
that we keep his commandments:
and his commandments are not grievous.
For whatsoever is born of God overcometh the world:
and this is the victory that overcometh the world,
even our faith.
Who is he that overcometh the world,
but he that believeth that Jesus is the Son of God?

Then he says:

This is he that came by water and blood, even Jesus Christ;
not by water only, but by water and blood.
And it is the Spirit that beareth witness,
because the Spirit is truth.

John 1 told you what that meant.

Verse 7 says:

For there are three that bear record in heaven,
the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost:
and these three are one.

There are three that bear record in heaven, and these three are one. This is the mighty, sovereign, omnipotent, one true and living God who consists of three Persons.

Then verse 8:

And there are three that bear witness in earth,
the Spirit, and the water, and the blood:
and these three agree in one.

The three in heaven bear record, and the three on earth bear witness that Jesus came the way it was prophesied and that He is who the Father said He is. Finally, you carry the witness in yourself because you have been born again.

Hallelujah. I love this.

First John 5:15 says:

And if we know that he hear us,
whatsoever we ask,
we know that we have the petitions that we desired of him.
If any man see his brother sin a sin which is not unto death,
he shall ask,
and he shall give him life for them that sin not unto death.
There is a sin unto death:
I do not say that he shall pray for it.
All unrighteousness is sin:
and there is a sin not unto death.
We know that whosoever is born of God sinneth not;
but he that is begotten of God keepeth himself,
and that wicked one toucheth him not.

Can I tell you what those two are? Yes. I can tell you about the life He gives you for someone who has not sinned the sin unto death. I can give you a little hint on the other one.

The sin being sinned unto death had to do with antichrist and changing the gospel. When judgment comes back, when it is restored and God is able to use the judgment gift the way He used the apostle Paul, Peter, and others in the book of Acts, it will probably be better to call it the mercy gift.

The judgment gift seems to belong up in the apostolic and prophetic area, but one reason not many operate in it is that it seems to be qualified by a mercy that rejoices against judgment. You cannot run in with a gleeful, happy heart and pronounce a death sentence on somebody. Generally, a judgment gift is an extreme act of mercy.

Remember when Paul judged Bar-Jesus, the Jewish sorcerer, on the island. Paul knew who he was and what he was. Bar-Jesus had influence with Sergius Paulus, the governor of the island. Sorcerers were held in high esteem and gave direction. When Paul came, Bar-Jesus opposed him.

Paul said:

O full of all subtilty and all mischief,
thou child of the devil,
thou enemy of all righteousness,
wilt thou not cease to pervert the right ways of the Lord?

Then darkness fell on him, and he was blinded for a season.

In Corinthians, they turned a man over to Satan for the destruction of the flesh that his spirit might be saved in the day of the Lord. Tell me, is that an act of mercy? I would much rather be the man who forfeited thirty years and has been in heaven for a long time than the man who lived those years and went to hell.

If I were that sorcerer, I would much rather be the sorcerer Paul judged who repented in blindness and accepted Jesus Christ than the sorcerer who lived and died without Paul visiting him and went to hell.

Think about it.

Before Jesus comes back, every gifting and office has to be in place and in full power. Solomon's temple and the tabernacle had to be built according to plan. Do you not know that for Him to harvest the precious fruit of the earth, the building of God made out of the spirits of just men made perfect must also come into order?

We need real apostles, not multi-level ones. We do not need a trinket revival or angels singing in our house when they should not be there. If you see an angel, they are not all good. Some angel-status beings are devils still. There are powers, principalities, rulers of darkness, and different classes.

We need real apostles and real prophets whom God backs up to the hilt. We want the miracles, but I want the fullness of the move. I want to see the mess it causes when a child born prisoner to a body that never worked, never spoke, blind, deaf, just lying there, is healed.

I want to see how it affects the relatives. I want to see how a hospital handles ten at once. How are they going to explain it to the city and the mayor?

He is just waiting for someone to fly.